

The Dhāraṇī Called Noble Avalokiteśvara

Ārya-Avalokiteśvara-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 696 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་སྐྱ་རས་གཟུགས་

Toh 696 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-Avalokiteśvara-nāma-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Pakpa Chenrezik Shyingkyong gi Nyingpo, meaning "The Dhāraṇī Called Noble Avalokiteśvara, Lord of the World." It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and is devoted to the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, the great embodiment of compassion, presenting a visualization of his white, four-armed form seated upon a lotus, sun, and moon seat and holding a crystal rosary and white lotus. The text opens by describing how Avalokiteśvara, moved by loving-kindness and compassion, gave rise to the awakening mind and manifests in this iconic form for the benefit of beings. As a dhāraṇī scripture, it combines devotional invocation, iconographic description, and the recitation of sacred syllables, with the promise that practitioners who engage with it will be reborn in the pure land of Sukhāvatī.

they will be reborn in the Blissful Land (Sukhāvatī). The Heart of Noble Avalokiteśvara is complete.

In the language of India: Ārya-Avalokiteśvara-nāma-dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Dhāraṇī Called Noble Avalokiteśvara, Lord of the World.

I pay homage to Noble Avalokiteśvara, endowed with great compassion.

Noble Avalokiteśvara, the Lord, arising from the state of loving-kindness, and impelled by the force of compassion, gave rise perfectly to the awakening mind. From the radiance and gathering of the syllable HRĪḤ upon a lotus, sun, and moon seat, he appears with one face and four arms: the first two hands are pressed together in añjali; the lower right hand holds a crystal rosary of pearl; the lower left hand holds a white lotus. His body is white, and he sits in the posture of complete vajra-cross-legged meditation. He is adorned with a variety of precious ornaments and beautified by a precious crown. His mother is the six-armed goddess; his father rests upon a precious jewel. Surrounded by vast numbers of bodhisattvas and female bodhisattvas, he spoke these words:

"O son of good family, or daughter of good family, if one merely recites this mantra once, or calls it to mind and holds it in one's heart, or writes it out and wears it upon one's body, or approaches it with faith and reverence — then all

five acts of immediate retribution (pañcānantarya), together with all sinful karmas related to them, will be purified. One will not be born in the three lower realms, nor in the eight states of non-leisure, nor in any place of suffering. One will be freed from every fear arising from humans, non-humans, and wild beasts. One will be liberated from all illness and harmful spirits.

By reciting OM MAṆI PADME HŪṢ, one will behold the face of Noble Avalokiteśvara, and at death one will be reborn in Sukhāvatī. Let no one entertain doubt, misgiving, or hesitation about this."

The Dhāraṇī of Noble Avalokiteśvara, Lord of the World, is complete.

Translator's Notes

- The opening line "they will be reborn in the Blissful Land" is clearly the conclusion of the preceding text (the Heart of Avalokiteśvara) and is included here as given at the head of this passage.

The description of the mother as "the six-armed goddess" renders "lha mo drug ma," which likely refers to Cundā or a specific tantric retinue goddess; the identity is not entirely certain from the text alone, but "six-armed goddess" is accurate to the literal reading.

The phrase rendered "sits in the posture of complete vajra-cross-legged meditation" translates "zhabs rdzogs pa'i skyil krung," literally "full lotus posture," the standard vajra-posture of seated meditation.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.